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PERFORMANCE TESTING REPORT

Rugby Outside Back Performance Profile

Sprint testing, power analysis and training recommendations

Applied degree project. Hypothetical academy-level rugby outside back. Test results are illustrative of how the work is analysed and are not a live athlete.

FOCUS 20 m Sprint | CMJ | Bronco | Trap-Bar Deadlift

KEY RESULTS

Test	Result	Interpretation	Practical implication
20 m Sprint	**3.32 s**	Acceleration strength	Maintain acceleration to develop max velocity
CMJ	**34.7 cm**	Power-development opportunity	Plyometric + ballistic emphasis
Bronco	**5:37**	Conditioning-development opportunity	RSA/HIIT focus
Trap-bar	**1.71× BM**	Relative-strength opportunity	Progressive maximal strength

BRIEF

A performance testing profile for a hypothetical academy-level rugby outside back, built as a university case-study project. The brief was to test key physical qualities relevant to the position and translate the results into training recommendations.

APPROACH

I selected a small, position-relevant test battery — 20 m sprint, countermovement jump (CMJ), the Bronco test for repeat-effort conditioning, and a 3RM trap-bar deadlift — and interpreted the results against normative and applied sport-science benchmarks for outside backs rather than treating each number in isolation.

RESULTS AND INTERPRETATION

3.32 s over 20 m is competitive acceleration and speed for the position. The ~34.7 cm CMJ shows a solid lower-body power output, though below what elite backs typically produce. A 5:37 Bronco time points to a conditioning base capable of repeat efforts across a match, with room to close the gap to elite repeat-sprint benchmarks. And a 1.71× bodyweight trap-bar deadlift is a reasonable absolute strength foundation, but below the ~2× BM often cited as a target for transferring strength into speed and power for backs.

RECOMMENDATIONS

I recommended a training emphasis on maximal and reactive strength development — to lift the 1.71× BM strength base toward a stronger, more transferable foundation — alongside continued exposure to max-velocity sprinting, while maintaining conditioning through repeat-sprint style work rather than long steady-state running.

REFLECTION

This project taught me that a single number rarely tells the full story — the CMJ and trap-bar results only became meaningful once I considered them together, and against what actually matters for an outside back's game: quick, repeated efforts at high speed, not raw one-off output.